

Duolingo Lesson JSON Guide

Updated reference for lesson structure, question types, and prompt templates

Purpose. This guide preserves the conventions established in this conversation so a new chat can continue building lesson configs without losing context. It now includes the noun-gender lesson refinement workflow in addition to the earlier pronoun and regular-conjugation patterns.

What a new chat should assume

- Lessons should build gradually from easier recognition to harder production.
- Use simple, tightly scaffolded sequences instead of jumping straight to open-ended typing.
- For chart-based conjugation lessons, use a 2 x 3 layout with singular on the left and plural on the right.
- Chart order should go 1st, 2nd, 3rd person from top to bottom.
- Use vosotros in the 2nd person plural slot for those chart lessons.
- For Spain-specific vosotros prompts, include “(Spain)” in the wording.
- When a question would have more than one valid answer, fix the answer choices instead of making the wording more complicated.
- Vocabulary or grammar targets should usually be introduced first before students are asked to analyze them.

1. Confirmed lesson-design rules

- Subject-pronoun lessons began with very basic meaning recognition, then added listening multiple choice, then typed production, then listening-to-English typing.
- Regular-conjugation lessons built on the pronoun lessons by pairing pronoun recognition with ending recognition and then a full conjugated form.
- Question groups can be intentionally chunked, such as pronoun -> ending -> full word, with periodic vocabulary-meaning review questions mixed in.
- For noun-gender lessons, the pattern should be: teach the typical endings first, introduce the noun with emoji and English meaning, then ask whether that noun is masculine or feminine.

2. Standard chart layout used in this conversation

	Singular	Plural
1st person	yo	nosotros
2nd person	tú	vosotros
3rd person	él / ella / usted	ellos / ellas / ustedes

Matching ending chart order

```
[  
  "o",    "-amos",  
  "as",   "-áis",  
  "a",    "-an"  
]
```

3. Confirmed and provisional question types

- Confirmed from this chat: table-select, listen-es-es, listen-es-en, translate-en-es, translate-es-en, and type-es-en-typed.
- Used as a working assumption for later lessons in this conversation: type-en-es-typed, type-listen-es-es-typed, and type-listen-es-en-typed. Those names should be verified against the actual app code if needed.

table-select

Tile- or chart-based multiple choice. Used for pronoun charts, ending charts, vocabulary recognition, and noun-gender recognition.

```
{  
  "type": "table-select",  
  "prompt": "Which Spanish word means 'to eat?',",  
  "tiles": ["🗣️ hablar", "🍴 comer", "📖 leer"],  
  "gridRows": 1,  
  "gridCols": 3,  
  "correctTile": "🍴 comer"  
}
```

listen-es-es

Hear Spanish and build or select the Spanish answer from a bank.

```
{
  "type": "listen-es-es",
  "spanish": "yo estoy estudiando ahora",
  "audio": "yo estoy estudiando ahora",
  "translation": "I am studying now.",
  "answer": ["estoy", "estudiando", "ahora"],
  "answerAlternates": ["yo", "estoy", "estudiando", "ahora"],
  "bank": ["yo", "estoy", "estudiando", "ahora", "estamos", "estudian", "estudiar"]
}
```

translate-en-es

See English and build the Spanish answer from a bank.

```
{
  "type": "translate-en-es",
  "sentence": "We are reading now.",
  "answer": ["estamos", "leyendo", "ahora"],
  "answerAlternates": ["nosotros", "estamos", "leyendo", "ahora"],
  "bank": ["nosotros", "estamos", "leyendo", "ahora", "están", "leen", "leer"],
  "audio": "nosotros estamos leyendo ahora"
}
```

listen-es-en

Hear Spanish and build the English answer from a bank.

```
{
  "type": "listen-es-en",
  "spanish": "ustedes están trabajando ahora",
  "audio": "ustedes están trabajando ahora",
  "translation": "Y'all are working now.",
  "answer": ["you", "all", "are", "working", "now"],
  "answerAlternates": ["you", "are", "working", "now"],
  "bank": ["you", "all", "are", "working", "now", "we", "they", "work"]
}
```

translate-es-en

See Spanish and build the English answer from a bank.

```
{
  "type": "translate-es-en",
  "sentence": "estamos estudiando ahora",
  "answer": ["we", "are", "studying", "now"],
  "answerAlternates": ["we", "re", "studying", "now"],
  "bank": ["we", "are", "studying", "now", "they", "study", "today"],
}
```

```
"audio": "estamos estudiando ahora"
}
```

type-es-en-typed

Typed response format explicitly provided by the user.

```
{
  "type": "type-es-en-typed",
  "sentence": "Tengo fiebre.",
  "answerText": "I have a fever",
  "answerTexts": [
    "I have fever",
    "I've got a fever"
  ],
  "audio": "Tengo fiebre",
  "info": "fever_info"
}
```

type-en-es-typed / type-listen-es-es-typed / type-listen-es-en-typed

Provisional formats used in planning later lesson stages in this conversation.

```
{
  "type": "type-en-es-typed",
  "sentence": "I",
  "answerText": "yo",
  "answerTexts": [],
  "audio": "yo"
}
```

4. Prompt blocks a human can copy into a new chat

Make me a config file for my Duolingo lesson. It should build gradually from easier recognition to harder production. Keep the first lesson simple, then add listening and typed production in later lessons. Use table-select for recognition questions.

Make me a config file for my Duolingo lesson. For chart-based conjugation questions, use a 2 wide by 3 tall table in chart order: singular on the left, plural on the right, with 1st, 2nd, and 3rd person going down. Use vosotros in the 2nd person plural slot.

Make me a config file for my Duolingo lesson. Keep the wording simple. If a question would have more than one valid answer, fix the answer choices instead of making the prompt more complicated.

Human examples preserved from this conversation

now add some listening ones where they have to listen to the pronoun and select the word they hear.

ok now for lesson 2 lets follow the same naming convention and lets start off with a couple of the basic questions again and then move on to the listening ones with the multiple choice, then lets move to typing them out after being given the word to translate. then for the 3rd lesson lets not have the easiest level and focus on the listening multiple choice, then typing from english prompt, then listening to spanish and typing out the word. finally, in the 4th lesson

we will follow that same pattern except we will add a new hardest level, listening to the spanish only and then typing the english translation.

ok now building on lesson 4 in a similar pattern where we include some of the previous material, i want to make lessons getting into regular conjugation. we will go a similar route where we will start with multiple choice and build from there. i want to start off with just the pronoun and conjugating a verb. 2 word sentences right now. to start off give the multiple choice basic question for the pronoun yo, where they select it from the chart, then the next question: "in the present tense, which ending matches 'yo'?" and then give them a chart with the endings in the same order as the previous charts. the endings should have a dash like this -o then go through all those endings. finally, at the end there should be some basic verbs in english and students will have to pick the correct spanish translation. the spanish translations should have a relevant emoji in it before the word. use basic verbs that have good emojis.

for this lesson use a 2 wide by 3 tall list of pronoun options in the same order as they have seen on charts. singular on the left plural on the right. 1st, 2nd, 3rd person going down. yo, tú, él / ella / usted, ect....

5. New refinement pattern from this conversation: noun gender lessons

Important update. A noun-gender lesson should not jump straight from ending rules to gender labels. First introduce each noun with an emoji and English meaning. Only after that should the lesson ask whether the noun is masculine or feminine.

Noun-gender lesson rules

- Start with two ending questions only: which ending is typically masculine, and which ending is typically feminine.
- For those first two questions, use exactly two options: -o and -a.
- After that, introduce nouns first with an English prompt and three emoji-labeled Spanish options.
- Choose nouns with normal -o or -a endings for the first lesson.
- Then ask whether the noun is masculine or feminine with only two options: masculine and feminine.
- Keep repeating the pattern noun introduction -> gender question for the rest of the lesson.

Copyable prompt for noun gender

Following this guide, give me a lesson over noun gender. Be sure to introduce items first using emojis. Give them an English prompt and 3 options. Pick nouns that have normal style o or a endings. First ask them 2 questions: which ending is typically masculine, which ending is typically feminine? Use only two options there: -o and -a. After that, introduce each noun before you ask about its gender. Then ask if it is masculine or feminine, with only those two options.

Example noun-gender JSON pattern

```
{
  "title": "Noun Gender Basics",
  "subtitle": "Lesson 1",
  "questions": [
    {
      "type": "table-select",
      "prompt": "Which ending is typically masculine?",
```

```

    "tiles": ["-o", "-a"],
    "gridRows": 1,
    "gridCols": 2,
    "correctTile": "-o"
  },
  {
    "type": "table-select",
    "prompt": "Which ending is typically feminine?",
    "tiles": ["-o", "-a"],
    "gridRows": 1,
    "gridCols": 2,
    "correctTile": "-a"
  },
  {
    "type": "table-select",
    "prompt": "Which Spanish word means 'cat'?",
    "tiles": ["🐱 gato", "📖 libro", "🍎 manzana"],
    "gridRows": 1,
    "gridCols": 3,
    "correctTile": "🐱 gato"
  },
  {
    "type": "table-select",
    "prompt": "🐱 gato - Is this masculine or feminine?",
    "tiles": ["masculine", "feminine"],
    "gridRows": 1,
    "gridCols": 2,
    "correctTile": "masculine"
  }
]
}

```

Correction loop captured from this conversation

following this guide, give me a lesson over noun gender. be sure to introduce items first using emojis. give them an english prompt and 3 options. pick nouns that have normal style o or a endings. first ask them 2 questions, which ending is typically masculine, which ending is typically feminine? after that just give them a noun and ask if it is masculine or feminine. their two options there should be masculine and feminine. then stick with that for the rest of the lesson.

use two options where it is asking about the ending just o and a

introduce the nouns in questions before you ask about their gender. those questions should be like the ones in the example doc like this:

```

{
  "type": "table-select",
  "prompt": "Which Spanish word means 'to eat'?",
  "tiles": ["🗣️ hablar", "🍽️ comer", "📖 leer"],
  "gridRows": 1,
  "gridCols": 3,

```

```
"correctTile": "🍷 comer"  
},
```

6. Practical reminders

- Keep JSON human-readable. Use consistent indentation and short prompts.
- When using emoji vocabulary options, keep the emoji attached to the Spanish word in the tile text.
- When building early lessons, do not add extra complexity that was not requested.
- If a new chat needs to continue a sequence, it should preserve the same naming convention: same concept title, then subtitle "Lesson 1", "Lesson 2", and so on.